ADAMA SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY AND TECHNOLOGY UNIVERSITY

DEPARTMENT OF SOFTWARE ENGINEERNG

Project Title: UniTrade Student Marketplace & Resource Exchange System

COURSE TITLE: Engineering Web Based System

CODE: SEng3202

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UniTrade Student Marketplace & Resource Exchange System

Project Overview

UniTrade is a dedicated student-to-student marketplace platform designed specifically for the ASTU community. The platform enables students to buy, sell, and exchange essential items like electronics, stationery, clothing, and even food. By restricting access to verified university emails and integrating with Telegram for communication, UniTrade provides a safe, efficient, and localized trading environment.

Key Objectives:

- Localized Economy: Facilitate easy trading within the campus.

- Safety & Trust: Verified student profiles and admin moderation.

- Efficiency: Instant communication via Telegram integration.

- User-Friendly Design: Modern, responsive interface built with Bootstrap 5.

Core Functionalities

👤 User Management

- Signup/Login: Students can register using their university email and details.

- Profile Management: Users can update their profile picture, Telegram username, and contact information.

- Verified Status: A badge system to identify verified student sellers.

Marketplace Features

-Smart Browsing: Items are categorized (Electronics, Clothes, Food, etc.) for easy discovery.

- Detailed Listings: High-quality images, descriptions, condition types (New/Used), and prices in ETB.

- Search & Filter: Find specific items quickly using keywords or categories.

📤 Selling System

- Item Listing: A simple form to upload item details and images.

- Approval Workflow: All listings are submitted for admin review to prevent spam or prohibited items.

- Status Tracking: Sellers can see if their item is 'Pending', 'Approved', or 'Rejected'.

💬 Communication & Integration

- Telegram Integration: Instead of a complex built-in chat, UniTrade uses Telegram usernames to bridge the gap between buyers and sellers instantly.

- Contact Support: A dedicated feedback system for users to report issues or suggest improvements.

3. System Architecture & Code Structure

Tech Stack

- Frontend: HTML5, CSS3 (Vanilla + Bootstrap 5.3), JavaScript.

- Backend: PHP 8.2 (Procedural and Object-Oriented patterns).

- Database: MySQL (hosted on XAMPP/Localhost).

- Icons: Bootstrap Icons.

Directory Structure

```
├── about.php
├── contact.php
├── generate_mock_images.php
├── generate_placeholders.php
├── index.php
├── item.php
├── login.php
├── logout.php
├── marketplace.php
├── profile.php
├──reset_admin.php
├── sell.php
├──signup.php
├──reset_admin.php
```

```
├── /admin
|   ├── dashboard.php
|   ├── items.php
|   ├── users.php
|   ├── edit_item.php
|   ├── messages.php
├── /includes
|   ├── db.php
|   ├── auth.php
|   ├── header.php
|   ├── footer.php
├── /css
|   └── style.css
├── /js
|   └── app.js
├── /uploads
|    ├── /categories
          ├── clothes.php
          ├── dorm.php
          ├── electronics.php
          ├── shoes.php
          ├── stationery.php
├── /database
|   └── unitrade.sql
```

Database Schema

The system relies on four primary tables:

1. Users: Stores credentials, profile info, and roles (Student/Admin).

2. Categories: Manages product classifications.

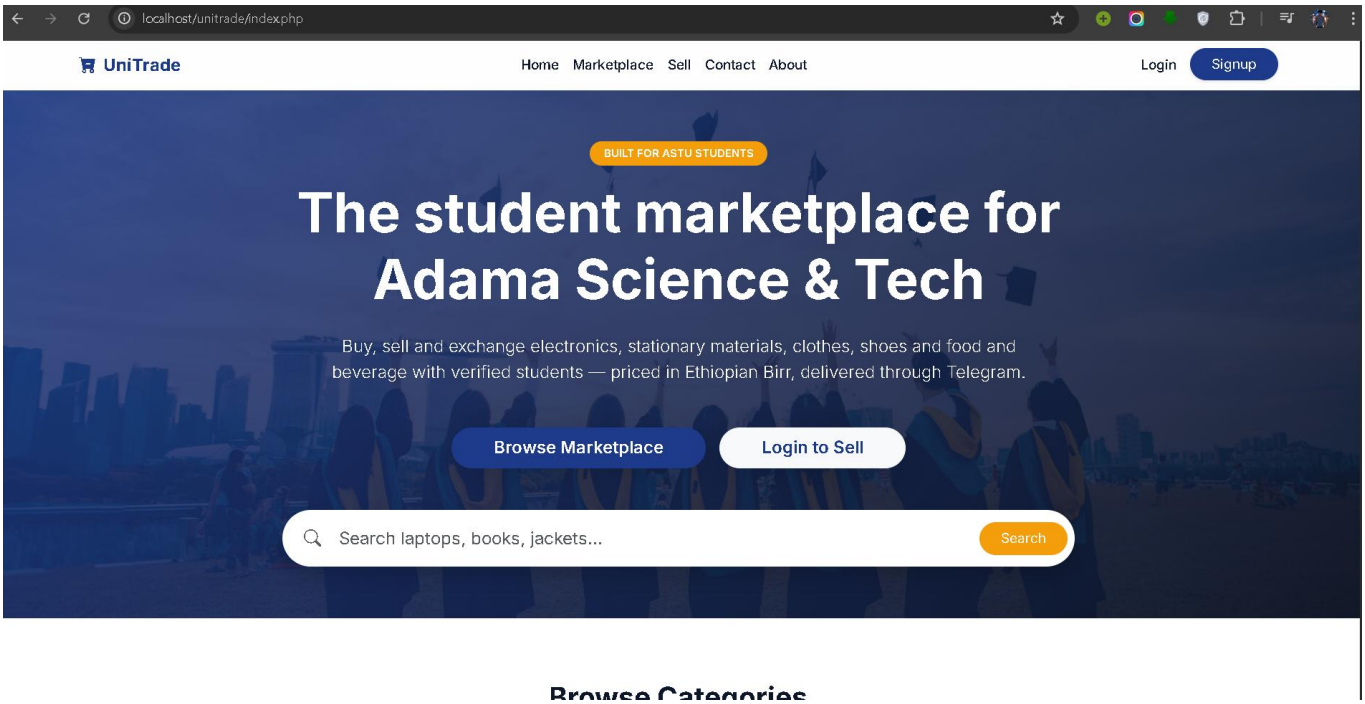
3. Items: Stores product details, pricing, and approval status.

4. Contact_Messages: Stores user inquiries.

4. Page Breakdown & Screenshots

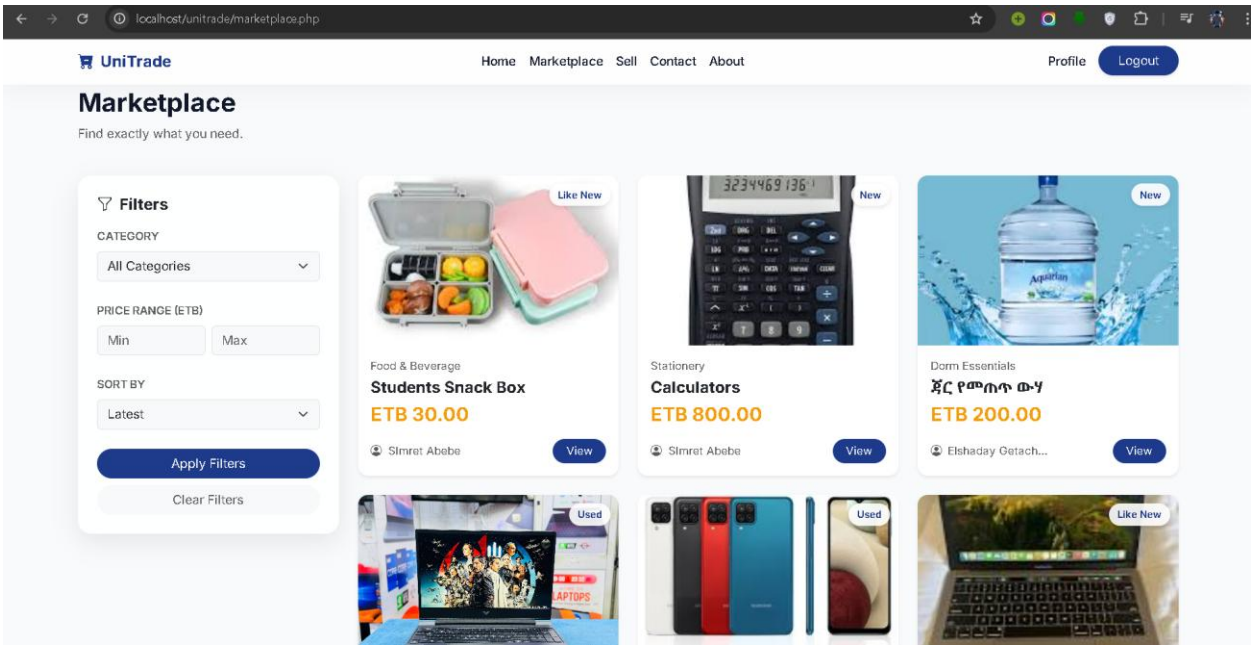
🏠 Home Page

The landing page features a hero section, search functionality, and a quick overview of why UniTrade is the best choice for ASTU students.



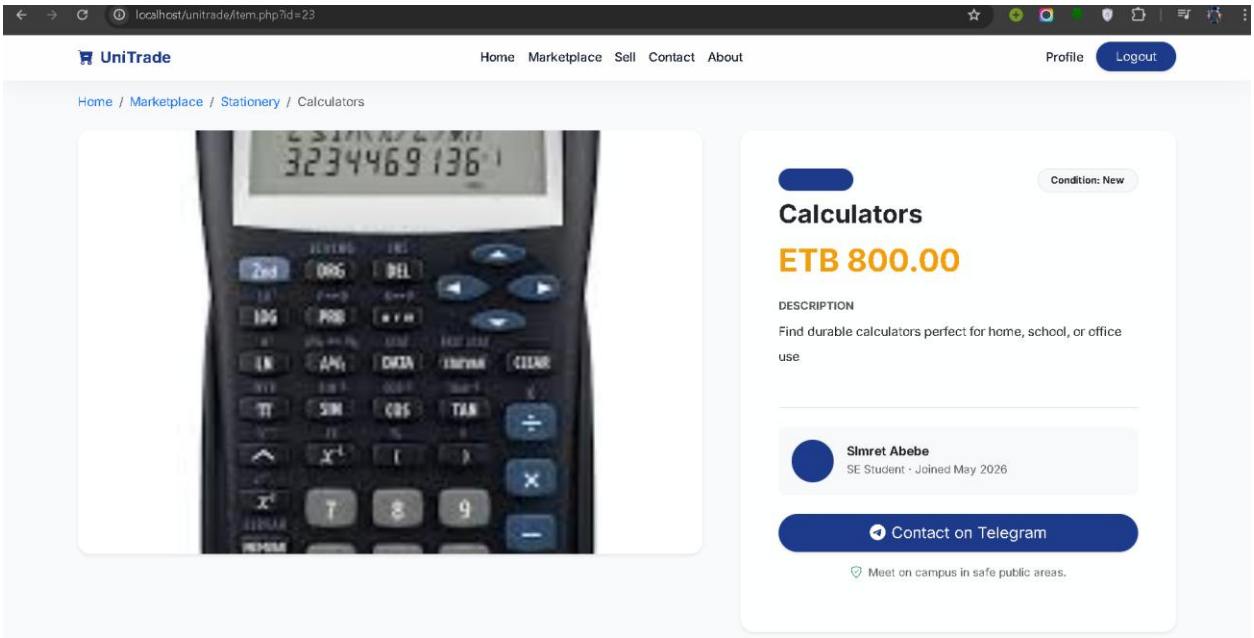
Marketplace

The central hub for browsing. It displays all approved listings with clear pricing and category badges.



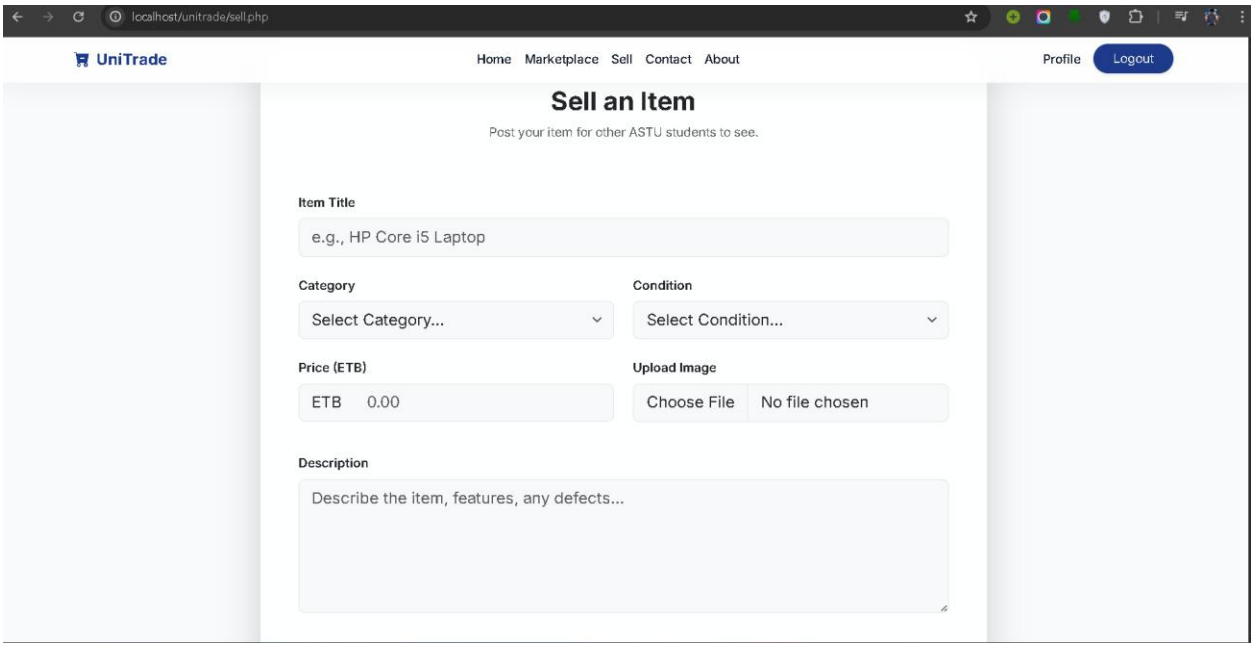
🎁 Item Details

Clicking an item reveals its full description, condition, and a direct "Contact Seller on Telegram" button.



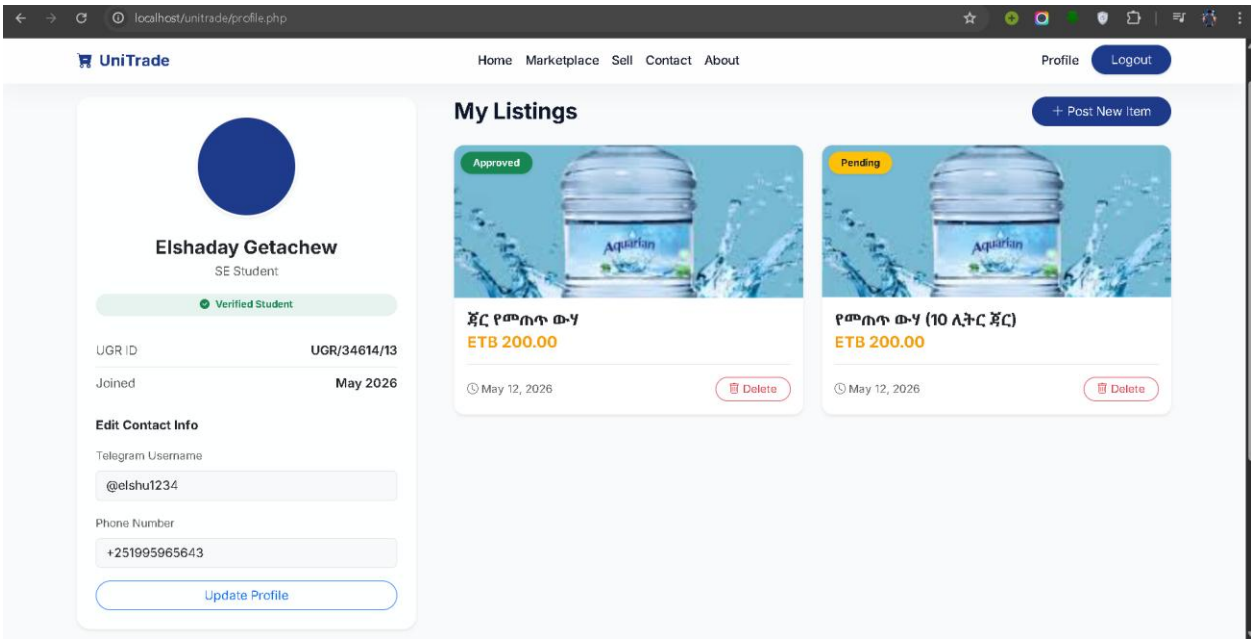
💵 Selling Form

A streamlined interface for sellers to input item specifications and upload high-resolution photos.



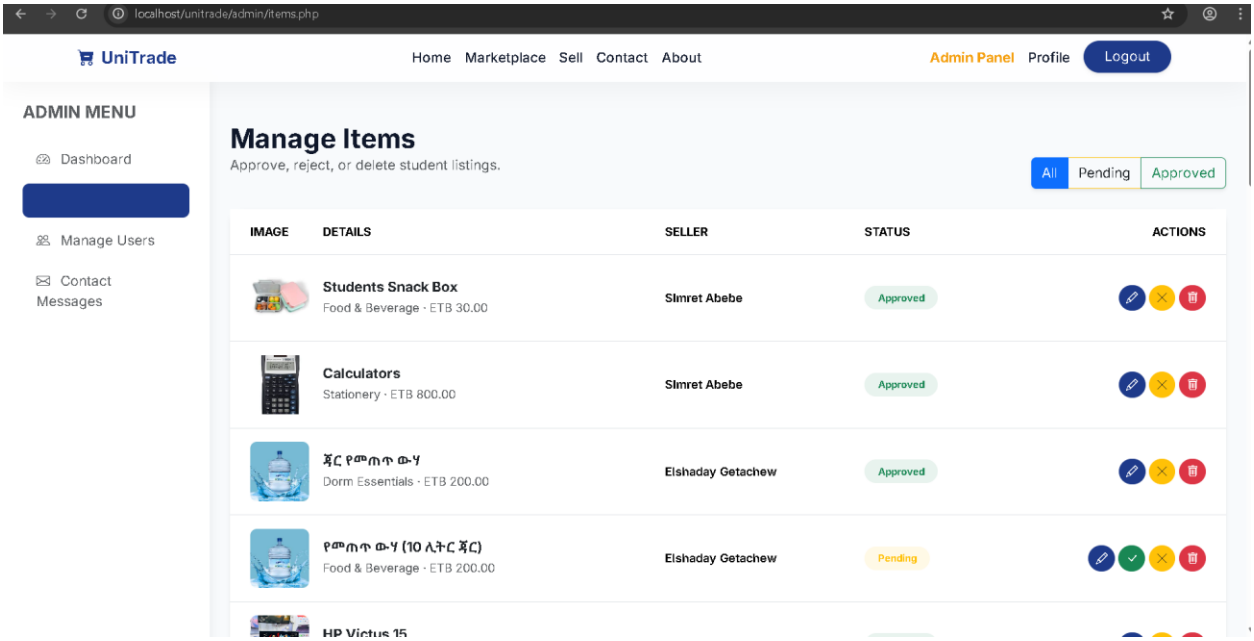
User Profile

Users can manage their active listings, see approval statuses, and update their personal information.



🛠Admin Dashboard

The command center where administrators can verify users, approve/reject listings, and manage categories.



Conclusion

UniTrade successfully bridges the gap in the student economy at ASTU. By combining a modern web interface with practical communication tools like Telegram, it provides a seamless experience for students to handle their secondary marketplace needs. The modular code structure ensures the platform can be easily scaled with future features like in-app payments or rating systems.